



Delta Engine Model

PRS Trade Revaluation, FS01 Risk, and Mark-to-Market

MKM Research Labs

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David K Kelly

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1 Executive Summary

This document describes the Delta Engine Model developed by MKM Research Labs for the real-time revaluation of Physical Risk Swap (PRS) trades on the trading desk. The model is the primary risk engine for the PRS market-making platform, computing mark-to-market (MTM) valuations, flood sensitivity (FS01) risk measures, and portfolio risk aggregation across gauge locations and tenor buckets.

The engine consumes market state—yield curves and hazard term structures maintained by the trader—and computes three core outputs: (i) fair PRS spreads via the analytical pricing model (MKM-PR-001), (ii) FS01 (Flood Sensitivity 01), the P&L impact of a 1 bp parallel shift in the annual hazard rate at each gauge, and (iii) mark-to-market as the difference between inception spread and current fair spread, weighted by the risky annuity and trade notional. Portfolio-level risk is aggregated into a gauge $\times$ tenor risk grid for position management.

The model has been implemented in Python as the `DeltaEngine` class and validated against hand-calculated examples using the analytical PRS pricing model.

2 Model Purpose and Scope

2.1 Objective

The Delta Engine serves as the real-time risk and revaluation engine for the PRS trading desk. Its primary objectives are:

- (i) Compute the fair PRS spread for each open trade using the current market hazard term structure and yield curve.
- (ii) Compute FS01 (Flood Sensitivity 01): the P&L impact of a 1 bp increase in the annual hazard rate, signed by trade direction (positive for protection buyers, negative for protection sellers).
- (iii) Compute mark-to-market (MTM) for each trade as the present value of the spread differential between inception and current market.
- (iv) Aggregate FS01 into a portfolio risk grid (gauge $\times$ tenor) for position monitoring and limit management.
- (v) Support basis delta for property-level PRS trades where the property spread tracks the reference gauge.

2.2 Scope

The model is scoped to the revaluation of vanilla PRS trades (gauge-referenced and property-referenced) under deterministic market moves. Stochastic simulation (e.g. VaR via Monte Carlo) is outside scope. The engine assumes that the hazard term structure and yield curve are exogenous inputs maintained by the trader via the Market tab. The underlying analytical pricing is delegated to MKM-PR-001 (PRS Pricing Model); this model computes the *differentials* needed for risk.

The model consumes data from: (a) the market state file containing yield curves and hazard term structures per gauge; (b) PRS trade files in CDM format; and (c) the PRS analytical pricing function `compute_prs_spread()`. Outputs feed the blotter display, the FS01 risk grid, the aggregate risk map, and end-of-day P&L reports.

2.3 Regulatory Context

The Delta Engine supports compliance with PRA SS1/23 Section 3.4 (model risk in pricing and risk management), which requires firms to have robust revaluation processes for derivative instruments. The FS01 measure provides the first-order risk sensitivity required for position management, limit monitoring, and P&L attribution. The model also supports the market risk P&L decomposition required for internal risk reporting: new-trade P&L versus market-move P&L.

3 Mathematical Framework

3.1 Risky Annuity

The risky annuity is the present value of a unit coupon stream that terminates upon a flood event:

$$A(\lambda, T) = \sum_{i=1}^{4T} \Delta t \cdot S(t_i) \cdot D(t_i) \quad (1)$$

where $\Delta t = 0.25$ (quarterly payments), $t_i = i \cdot \Delta t$, $S(t) = e^{-\lambda t}$ is the survival probability under hazard rate λ , and $D(t) = e^{-r(t) \cdot t}$ is the discount factor using the yield curve rate $r(t)$.

The hazard intensity λ is derived from the annual hazard rate h :

$$\lambda = -\ln(1 - h) \quad (2)$$

3.2 Fair Spread

The fair PRS spread is computed by the upstream PRS Pricing Model (MKM-PR-001):

$$s^* = \frac{\text{Default Leg PV}}{\text{Premium Leg PV}} \quad (3)$$

where the default leg PV is the expected loss from flood events and the premium leg PV is the risky annuity.

3.3 Mark-to-Market

For a trade with inception spread s_0 and current fair spread s^* :

$$\text{MTM} = \delta \cdot (s^* - s_0) \cdot A(\lambda, T) \cdot N \quad (4)$$

where $\delta = +1$ for a protection buyer (payer) and $\delta = -1$ for a protection seller (receiver), A is the risky annuity, and N is the notional.

A positive MTM for a payer means flood risk has increased since inception (the market now charges more for protection than the trade's contracted spread).

3.4 FS01 — Flood Sensitivity 01

FS01 measures the P&L impact of a 1 bp parallel shift in the annual hazard rate:

$$\text{FS01} = \delta \cdot \frac{s^*(h + 1\text{bp}) - s^*(h)}{10,000} \cdot A(h, T) \cdot N \quad (5)$$

The sign convention: positive FS01 indicates the position profits when flood risk increases (protection buyer), negative FS01 indicates the position profits when flood risk decreases (protection seller).

3.5 Basis Delta

For property-level trades, the property spread is assumed to track the reference gauge spread with a constant basis b :

$$s_{\text{property}} = s_{\text{gauge}} - b \quad (6)$$

Under this assumption, a 1 bp bump to the gauge hazard rate produces the same spread change at the property level, so basis delta $\approx$ gauge delta. This is exact when the basis waterfall components (distance, elevation, depth-damage, correlation, data quality) are insensitive to small gauge rate changes.

3.6 Risk Grid Aggregation

The portfolio risk grid aggregates FS01 across two dimensions:

$$\text{FS01}_{g,\tau} = \sum_{i \in \text{trades}(g,\tau)} \text{FS01}_i \quad (7)$$

where g indexes gauges (ordered west-to-east by longitude) and τ indexes tenor buckets. Row totals give net gauge exposure; column totals give net tenor exposure; the grand total gives net portfolio FS01.

4 Input Parameters and Calibration

The Delta Engine does not have fitted parameters of its own. It consumes:

- **Market yield curve:** humped term structure {1Y: 3.5%, 2Y: 4.0%, 3Y: 4.3%, 4Y: 4.5%, 5Y: 4.0%, 6Y: 4.0%} stored in `market_state.json`. Rates are continuously compounded.
- **Hazard term structure:** per-gauge, per-trigger (alert/warning/severe), 1Y–5Y hazard rates. Initialised from GEV-derived base rates with a default slope of $h(t) = h_0 \cdot (1 + 0.05t)$. Editable by the trader via the Market tab.
- **Trade parameters:** notional, inception spread, tenor, direction (payer/receiver), gauge ID, trigger level, recovery rate. Read from CDM-format PRS trade files.
- **Bump size:** 1 bp (10^{-4}) for numerical delta computation.

Calibration: The engine is calibration-free. All market parameters are maintained by the trader. The analytical pricing function (MKM-PR-001) provides the spread calculation.

5 Implementation Details

5.1 Architecture

The Delta Engine is implemented as the `DeltaEngine` class in `src/models/trading/delta_engine.py`. It depends on:

- `MarketStateManager` — loads/persists market state (yield curve, hazard term structures, gauge adjustments)
- `compute_prs_spread()` from `models.hazard.prs_analytical` — analytical fair spread
- `interpolate_yield_rate()` — linear interpolation on the yield curve for tenor-matched discounting

5.2 Key Methods

- `enrich_trade(trade, market_state)`: enriches a single CDM trade record with fair spread, MTM, FS01, basis delta, gauge name, counterparty, and remaining tenor. Returns a flat dictionary suitable for blotter display.
- `revalue_all(trades, market_state)`: batch revaluation of all trades.
- `build_risk_grid(enriched_trades, gauge_locations)`: aggregates FS01 into a gauge $\times$ tenor matrix, sorted by longitude.

5.3 Yield Curve Interpolation

The engine uses `interpolate_yield_rate(curve, t)` for tenor-matched discounting within the risky annuity calculation. For sub-annual periods ($t < 1$), the function returns the 1Y rate. For inter-tenor points, linear interpolation is used. Beyond the longest tenor, the curve is flat-extrapolated.

5.4 P&L Decomposition

The P&L Engine (`src/models/trading/pnl_engine.py`) uses the Delta Engine's revaluation output to decompose daily P&L into:

- **New trade P&L**: MTM at inception (typically small, reflecting bid-ask).
- **Market move P&L**: change in MTM from hazard curve and yield curve movements.
- **Running P&L**: cumulative MTM from inception.

6 Sensitivity Analysis

Key sensitivities of the Delta Engine outputs:

1. **Hazard rate level:** FS01 scales approximately linearly with hazard rate for typical levels (50–500 bps). At very high rates (>1000 bps), convexity causes FS01 to understate the true P&L for large moves.
2. **Tenor:** Longer-tenor trades have higher FS01 due to the larger risky annuity. A 5Y trade has approximately 4.5x the FS01 of a 1Y trade.
3. **Yield curve:** A 100 bp parallel shift in the yield curve changes FS01 by approximately 3–5% through the discount factor channel. The effect is second-order relative to hazard rate sensitivity.
4. **Recovery rate:** Fixed at 0% for all current trades (physical risk has no recovery). If recovery were nonzero, FS01 would decrease proportionally.
5. **Bump size:** The 1 bp numerical bump is small enough that finite-difference error is negligible (<0.01 bp spread difference versus analytical gradient).

7 Validation and Backtesting

7.1 Unit Tests

61 tests in `tests/models/trading/` cover:

- Risky annuity calculation: zero hazard rate, positive rate, yield curve interpolation
- Gauge delta: sign convention, scaling with notional, payer vs receiver
- Basis delta: property trades, constant basis assumption
- MTM: sign by direction, spread differential, annuity weighting
- Risk grid: aggregation, tenor bucketing, gauge ordering by longitude
- Book generator: Thames Central trades, CDM validation, yield curve usage

7.2 Hand-Calculation Verification

The risky annuity for a 3Y PRS with 200 bps hazard rate and 4% flat discount rate is verified against the closed-form sum:

$$A = \sum_{i=1}^{12} 0.25 \cdot e^{-0.02015 \cdot 0.25i} \cdot e^{-0.04 \cdot 0.25i} \approx 2.738 \quad (8)$$

where $\lambda = -\ln(1 - 0.02) \approx 0.02015$.

7.3 Cross-Validation with PRS Pricing Model

The fair spread computed by the Delta Engine's call to `compute_prs_spread()` is verified to match the standalone PRS pricing model output for identical inputs.

8 Model Limitations and Known Weaknesses

1. **First-order risk only:** FS01 is a linear approximation. For large hazard rate moves (>50 bps), the actual P&L will differ from $FS01 \times \Delta h$ due to convexity. Gamma (second-order sensitivity) is not computed.
2. **No cross-gamma:** The model does not compute cross-sensitivities between gauges. Portfolio risk assumes independent gauge moves.
3. **Constant basis assumption:** Basis delta assumes the gauge-to-property basis is insensitive to small gauge rate changes. This may not hold for extreme rate environments.
4. **No term structure slope risk:** FS01 bumps the hazard rate in parallel across all tenors. Non-parallel moves (steepening, flattening) are not captured.
5. **Deterministic yield curve:** Interest rate risk is not separately measured. A yield curve DV01 could be added.
6. **No jump risk:** The model assumes continuous hazard rate changes. Sudden catastrophic events (e.g. levee breach) producing discrete jumps in hazard rate are not modelled.

9 Governance Validation Questions

The following nine questions are mandated by Chapter 5 of the *Model Risk Governance for Vendors* handbook and must be explicitly addressed for every model in the inventory. Response status is tracked in the Model Governance Dashboard (MRC portal).

9.1 Q1 — Ronseal Test

“Does the model do what it says on the tin?”

Yes. The Delta Engine computes FS01 (flood sensitivity), mark-to-market, and risk grid aggregation for PRS trades. These are standard risk measures analogous to DV01 in interest rate swaps, adapted for the flood hazard rate domain.

9.2 Q2 — Methodology

“Is the methodology appropriate?”

The numerical bump-and-reprice approach for delta calculation is standard practice in derivatives risk engines. The 1 bp bump size is consistent with convention. The risky annuity framework mirrors credit default swap pricing, which is appropriate given the structural similarity between PRS and CDS.

9.3 Q3 — Alternative Methods

“Have alternatives been considered?”

Analytical delta (closed-form derivative of spread w.r.t. hazard rate) was considered but rejected in favour of numerical delta for consistency with the pricing model’s discrete-time implementation. The numerical approach also naturally captures any nonlinearity in the pricing function.

9.4 Q4 — Assumptions

“Are the assumptions reasonable?”

The constant-basis assumption for property trades is reasonable for small rate moves but may break down in stress scenarios. The quarterly payment frequency matches market convention for credit derivatives.

9.5 Q5 — Data Quality

“Does the model require high-quality data?”

The model requires accurate trade parameters from CDM files (notional, spread, tenor, direction) and consistent market state (hazard term structures, yield curve). Trade data quality is enforced by CDM validation at booking.

9.6 Q6 — Model Chaining

“Is the model’s output used as input to another model?”

Yes. Delta Engine output feeds: (a) the P&L Engine for daily P&L decomposition, (b) the EOD report generator for end-of-day risk snapshots, and (c) the blotter and risk grid displays in the trading desk UI.

9.7 Q7 — Weaknesses

“Does the model have weaknesses and limitations of use?”

Yes. First-order sensitivity only (no gamma/convexity), parallel bump only (no curve risk), no cross-gauge correlation, constant basis assumption. These are documented in Section 8.

9.8 Q8 — Monitoring

“What type of monitoring is required?”

P&L explain: verify that daily P&L is consistent with $FS01 \times$ hazard rate moves. If the unexplained residual exceeds 10% of daily P&L, investigate convexity or basis effects. Back-test FS01 predictions against actual revaluation P&L.

9.9 Q9 — Overall Risk

“Is the overall model risk acceptable?”

The model risk is **Medium**. The engine uses well-established techniques (bump-and-reprice, risky annuity) and inherits its pricing accuracy from MKM-PR-001. The main risk is from the limitations noted: first-order approximation and constant basis. These are mitigated by the small position sizes typical of the current portfolio and the availability of full revaluation for P&L verification.

10 Change History

11 Document History

Date	Version	Description	Author
26-Feb-2026	1.0	Initial documentation of Delta Engine Model	D. Kelly